



Mobile App Development: What a Developer Needs to Know

What are the basic skill sets required for a developer of mobile apps?



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Anyone trying their hand at mobile app development should have a programming background. An engineering degree like B.Tech and MCA is required; even a BCA candidate can get into the business after some training. Also, one should have hands-on experience on Java and C++. Candidates skilled at Java can get into Android apps development. For developing iPhone apps, knowledge of Objective-C is a must. There are some more frameworks available, but these are the basic prerequisites.

Do mobile app developers have a role to play in app monetisation?

Yes, but only to a certain extent. Eighty per cent of app monetisation is handled by the entrepreneurs (who think up or envision and market an app), while 20 per cent is where developers have a role to play. But there are a couple of third party APIs, including Google, that can be integrated in the app while designing it, which can add to that app's monetisation. Suppose a developer has made a gaming app, the best audience for it will be gamers using other gaming apps. So by displaying an ad for his app on other gaming apps, he can attract the gamers to his app. Similarly, if someone else advertises on his app, that person could earn.



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First, the developer should have basic coding knowledge in languages like Java, J2ME and Dalvik, which is a specialised technology stack required for the development of Android apps along with SDKs. Apart from this, the developer should be sound logic-wise and should have analytical rigour.

Yes, to a certain extent. The developer should create a robust application model to ensure that the end user is not only able to download the app perfectly, but is also able to retain the app. App monetisation is directly proportional to not only the higher number of downloads but also on their retention on user devices over a long period. So that is the primary duty of the developer.



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An app developer needs to possess the unique capability to build apps across diverse categories such as gaming, business, utility, entertainment, infotainment, etc. It is also imperative for them to customise the app by understanding the users' mind set, while grasping advanced technologies and adapting to the dynamic ecosystem. The superior competencies required for developers are experience with graphics, UI/UX and extensive coding. Apart from the basic technical skills, a developer is required to clearly understand the nature of the mobile app development profession.

Yes, definitely—every mobile app developer plays a key role in monetising his or her app. App developers need to have an inclusive monetisation model for a successful app strategy—one that targets users who are willing to pay for apps (to upgrade features, remove ads, etc). They must also consider users (primarily from emerging markets) who prefer free app downloads. A blend of these two will give app developers the best results in terms of reach and revenues.